BRAND STYLE GUIDE · 2026 · GEORGIA PEACH & CLAY

Vote GA

Informing the Electorate

Visual standards, color system, typography, and UI patterns for the VoteGA civic information platform.

votega.org · Georgia Voter Information



CONTENTS

01 Mission & Voice
02 Logo & Identity
03 Color System
04 Typography
05 Badges & Labels
06 Buttons & Controls
07 Cards & Callouts
08 Data Display
09 Party Color System
10 Spacing & Layout
11 Iconography
12 Data Visualization
13 Content & Data States
14 Social & Share Cards
15 Legal & Attribution
16 Layout & Breakpoints
17 Page Anatomy
18 Hub & Results Pages
19 Open Items

01 — MISSION & VOICE

Informing the Electorate

VoteGA is a nonpartisan civic information resource for Georgia voters. The brand should feel authoritative, transparent, and accessible — like a trusted local newspaper, not a political campaign.

> *“Informing the electorate.”*
> VoteGA tagline — short, neutral, and purposeful

Voice (Do)
Factual and precise. Uses plain language. Acknowledges data gaps honestly. Explains API limitations clearly. Cites sources. Never editorializes on candidates.

Avoid
Partisan framing. Emotional language around political figures. Promoting one party’s positions. Hiding data quality caveats. Making unsupported claims.

02 — LOGO & IDENTITY

Logo Usage

The mark is Georgia’s outline in a round badge, built from US Census boundary data. The wordmark pairs ‘Vote’ and ‘GA’ — Georgia’s postal abbreviation doubles as a call to action.



Light / warm background — primary usage (Tier 1)



Navbar / footer (#f4ebe0)

ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION
Logo file	Current site file is /assets/img/logo.png (red/blue, still to be swapped). The outlined SVG and PNG set of the marks shown here is in assets/img/brand/logo/.
Mark	Georgia outline in a round badge, set before the wordmark. See the Logo System page.
Placement	Top-left navbar, replaces title text via title-img
Domain	votega.org — lowercase, no hyphen

02 — LOGO & IDENTITY

Logo System: Tiers & Usage

One identity, two sets. The **Georgia set** is the primary identity; the **peach set** is an alternate for warmer, more expressive uses. Georgia says *where*; the peach says *who and how it feels*.

TIER 1 · PRIMARY

VoteGA
INFORMING THE ELECTORATE

With tagline: headers, documents, OG image, anywhere over about 320px wide.

VoteGA

No tagline: the same Tier 1 logo for the navbar and small sizes, where the tagline would be unreadable.

TIER 2 · STACKED

VOTE
GA

Use only when horizontal space is short: square crops, posters, narrow columns.

ALTERNATE SET · PEACH

VoteGA
INFORMING THE ELECTORATE

VOTE
GA

VOTE INFORMED
VOTEGA.ORG

Avatars, merch, stickers, campaigns, slogans.

WHICH MARK WHERE

CONTEXT	MARK
Browser tab, bookmarks, favicon, PWA / touch icons	**Georgia** favicon
Site header, documents, reports, OG image	**Georgia**, Tier 1 (Tier 2 if narrow)
Social avatars and profile images	**Peach** set
Merch, stickers, print, campaigns, slogans	**Peach** set

RULES

Do. Pick one set per placement. Clear space around the logo equals a quarter of the badge diameter. Drop the tagline under about 320px wide. Use the favicon (Georgia) for every small icon.

Don't. Mix a Georgia badge and a peach in one lockup. Use the peach as a favicon (the leaf is lost at 16px). Recolor to blue or red, or place on a background that drops the 3:1 contrast.

Minimum sizes and clear space are proposed values; confirm them in real use before they are treated as fixed.

03 — COLOR SYSTEM

Core Palette: Georgia Peach & Clay

The palette is built around a warm clay brand color, a deep clay for interactive states, and a pine accent. It deliberately contains **no blue and no red**, so the brand never collides with party colors. Party colors are semantic, not brand — they encode political affiliation and must not be used decoratively. Contrast ratios are measured against the page background.

PRIMARY BRAND COLORS

Ink
`#2b2118`
Body text, headings
15.2:1 on page

Brand Clay
`#b4521f`
Accents, focus ring, tab underline
4.9:1 on page

Deep Clay
`#8a3b12`
Buttons, active states, hover
7.5:1 on page

Link
`#9a4214`
Text links
6.4:1 on page

Pine
`#2f5d50`
Secondary accent, authorization badge
7.2:1 on page

BACKGROUND & SURFACE

Page
`#fffaf4`
Page background

Clay Tint
`#fbefe4`
Hover rows, banners, badge BG

Navbar / Footer
`#f4ebe0`
Navbar, footer surfaces

Clay Line
`#e6c9b0`
Borders, dividers, inputs

Nav Border
`#e6d8c6`
Navbar bottom border

Pine Tint
`#e3eeea`
Pine badge / card BG

SEMANTIC STATUS COLORS

Success Green
`#15803d`
Confirmed, certified
4.8:1 on page

Danger Red
`#b91c1c`
Errors, emergencies
6.2:1 on page

Warning Amber
`#806000`
Cautions, data notes
5.6:1 on page

Neutral Gray
`#6b7280`
Meta text, disabled
4.7:1 on page

Contrast notes. Brand Clay on Clay Tint is just under AA (4.46:1) — use Deep Clay for text on tints (badges, banners). White on Brand Clay is 5.0:1 and passes AA. Warning Amber is a golden brown, kept apart from the clay family, and is still always paired with a label or icon: under some color-blind vision dark browns converge, so color alone never carries the meaning.

Dark mode: not in this release. Build every color as a token named by its *role* (surface, text, border, accent, link, party), layered over the palette values above, and keep raw hex out of components. A dark theme can then be added later by overriding the role tokens, not by editing pages. The logo set already includes reversed versions for dark grounds; the peach set is light-ground only.

04 — TYPOGRAPHY

Type Scale

VoteGA uses **Public Sans** for everything — headings and body — loaded from Google Fonts, with an explicit monospace stack for IDs, order numbers and code: `ui-monospace, 'SF Mono', Consolas, 'Liberation Mono', monospace`. Never rely on the bare `monospace` keyword, which resolves to a different face on every OS. Public Sans is also the face of the VoteGA wordmark, so type and logo share one voice. Hierarchy comes from weight and size, not from a second family.

STYLE	EXAMPLE
H1 — Page Title · Public Sans Bold, 20–24pt	**Legislative Member Details**
H2 — Section Heading · Public Sans Bold, 16pt	**Georgia Executive Offices**
H3 — Sub-heading · Public Sans Bold, 11pt	**Voting History · 119th Congress**
Body · Public Sans Regular, 9–10pt, leading 14	Figures reflect the candidate's most recent filing and are updated as new reports are submitted to the FEC.
Small / Meta · 7–8pt, #6b7280	Data updated daily · Source: Congress.gov API · Last sync: October 2026
Monospace · 8–8.5pt, IDs and order numbers	`Order 10.08.26.01 · BioGuide ID K000394`
Category Label · Public Sans Bold 6.5pt, uppercase, tracked	STATE OF GEORGIA · 2026 ELECTION CYCLE · CONGRESSIONAL REPRESENTATIVES
Link · Public Sans, #9a4214	gov.georgia.gov 6.4:1 on page

05 — BADGES & LABELS

Status & Category Badges

Badges are pill-shaped (border-radius 10–12px), small text, bold weight. They encode meaning through background/foreground color pairs — never use color alone without a text label. Contrast ratio shown beside each badge.

ROLE BADGES

- Current Officeholder 6.8:1
- Challenger 9.4:1
- Open Seat 5.3:1

EXECUTIVE-ORDER CATEGORIES

- State of Emergency 5.5:1
- Election 5.0:1
- Suspension 8.2:1
- Appointment 6.8:1
- Authorization 6.3:1
- Flag at Half-Staff 8.5:1
- Other 6.8:1

PARTY & SEAT BADGES (SEMANTIC)

- Democratic 5.6:1
- Republican 4.6:1
- Independent 5.2:1
- Vacant 9.4:1

06 — BUTTONS & CONTROLS

Buttons, Filters & Tabs

Primary actions use Deep Clay with white text (7.7:1). Focus is always a 3px Brand Clay outline with a 2px offset — never remove it.

BUTTONS

Find my districts | Clear lookup | Focused

FILTER & YEAR BUTTONS

All (318) | Appointment (257) | Hover state | 2026 | 2025

TABS

GA State Senate | GA House of Representatives

INPUTS

123 Peachtree St NE, Atlanta, GA 30303 — or just 30303

07 — CARDS & CALLOUTS

Candidate Cards & Callout Banners

Cards communicate role. Callout banners communicate contextual status with a 4px left border. Accent colors are non-partisan; only the party badge carries party color.

CANDIDATE CARDS

Current Officeholder

Sen. Jon Ossoff

D Georgia · U.S. Senate

Challenger

Candidate Name

R Georgia · U.S. Senate

CALLOUT BANNERS

Primary Result
This seat advances to the General Election on November 3, 2026.

Open Seat
The current officeholder is not seeking re-election to this seat.

Running for Re-Election
This member has filed to run for the same seat in 2026.

Data Note
Member data not found. Verify the memberId matches the data file.

08 — DATA DISPLAY

Finance Cards & Data Tables

Financial summary cards use tinted backgrounds to encode meaning at a glance. Tables use minimal styling — subtle header, light row borders, and a Clay Tint row hover.

CAMPAIGN FINANCE SUMMARY CARDS

RAISED
$2.4M

SPENT
$1.1M

CASH ON HAND
$1.3M

DATA TABLE (EXECUTIVE ORDERS EXAMPLE)

DATE	ORDER #	TITLE	CATEGORY
Oct 8, 2026	10.08.26.01	Declaring a State of Emergency for Hurricane Isaias	State of Emergency 5.5:1
Oct 6, 2026	10.06.26.21	Reappointing the Honorable Antonio Long to the Georgia Board of Private Detective and Security Agencies (hover row)	Appointment 6.8:1
Oct 6, 2026	10.06.26.19	Reappointing the Honorable Coy Heath Elliott to the Board of Community Supervision	Appointment 6.8:1

09 — PARTY COLOR SYSTEM

Political Party Colors

Party colors are semantic, not decorative — they encode political affiliation only, and are the **only** blues, reds and magentas in content areas. Each party has **one color, taken from its own disc**: that hue means that party and nothing else, on every page, chart, badge and card. Gray marks a vacant seat, not a party. Never use Democratic blue or Republican red as general accent colors. With the clay brand there is no brand blue, so general UI (links, buttons, tabs, active states) never needs one.

Democratic
`#3333ff`
Chart, bar, border; the disc

Democratic tint
`#e7e7ff`
Badge background

Republican
`#e81b23`
Chart, bar, border; the disc

Republican text
`#cf151c`
Small text on its tint

Republican tint
`#fce4e5`
Badge background

Independent
`#a21caf`
Chart, bar, border, badge text

Independent tint
`#f4e4f5`
Badge background

Vacant
`#9ca3af`
Charts, vacant seats

Vacant tint
`#f3f4f6`
Badge background

PARTY SYMBOLS (DISCS)



Democratic

democratic-disc.svg



Republican

republican-disc.svg

Usage

- **Identify, never decorate.** Use a disc only to mark a party affiliation, next to a party label (“D”, “Democratic”) — never as ornament or in the VoteGA logo.
- **Always in pairs, same size.** Where one party’s disc appears, show the other’s alongside at identical size and weight. Independent has no disc: use its magenta text badge. Vacant seats use gray.
- **Use the artwork as supplied.** Don’t recolor, outline, crop, rotate or add effects. Both are self-contained discs with a white field, so they sit on any background.
- **Size (proposed).** 16px minimum, since detail is lost below that; about 20–24px inline with text, 40–80px on cards.
- **The discs are the party colors.** The artwork and the palette are the same hues, so a disc, a badge and a chart bar for one party always match. The one adjustment: Republican red is 3.7:1 on its tint, so small badge text uses the darker text shade (4.6:1).
- **Not an endorsement.** The discs are party marks. State that data is nonpartisan where they appear in prominent positions, and never place one beside editorial content.

Correct use

Use Democratic blue on charts and candidate cards representing Democratic candidates. Apply party colors consistently and symmetrically across both parties.

Incorrect use

Don’t use Democratic blue for non-party UI such as links, buttons or tabs — those use the clay family. Don’t use Republican red as a general ‘danger’ or ‘error’ color; reserve Danger Red for errors and emergencies, and always pair it with a text label or icon.

10 — SPACING & LAYOUT

Spacing Tokens & Layout

The layout uses a single-column content area with a sticky sidebar on member detail pages.

TOKEN	VALUE	USED FOR
xs	0.25rem / 4px	Gap between badge and icon
sm	0.5rem / 8px	Gap between filter buttons
md	1rem / 16px	Card padding, section gaps
lg	1.25–1.5rem	Between sections
xl	2rem	Section separators, page margins

TOKEN	VALUE	USED FOR
Radius sm	4px	Year buttons
Radius md	6–8px	Cards, callouts
Radius pill	10–20px	Filter buttons, badges
Avatar	80 / 140px	Cards / detail pages
Sidebar	240px	State member sidebar
Breakpoint	600–700px	Stack to single column

LEFT-BORDER ACCENT SYSTEM (4PX)

Incumbent
`#b4521f`

Challenger
`#9ca3af`

Primary result
`#2f5d50`

Open seat
`#806000`

IMPLEMENTATION

Tokens live in `assets/css/brand-peach.css` (trial; loaded per page via front matter `css:`). Page background, text, link, hover, navbar and footer use the theme variables `--page-col`, `--text-col`, `--link-col`, `--hover-col`, `--navbar-col`, `--footer-col`.

11 — ICONOGRAPHY

Icon System

Pragmatic and structured. One family — **Font Awesome 6 Free, solid**, already loaded site-wide — plus the party discs for affiliation and a single Unicode star for the current officeholder. Each icon has one meaning, so the same idea always looks the same across the site.

ROLE & STATUS

★ **Current Officeholder** Kept as the text glyph in the role badge; inherits the badge color `U+2605 (text)`	**Candidates** A field of candidates in a race `fa-people-group`	**Open Seat** Officeholder is not seeking re-election `fa-door-open`	**Vacant Seat** Seat currently unfilled `fa-chair`	**Filed / Qualified** Candidate has qualified for the ballot `fa-user-check`	**Certified** Results certified `fa-circle-check`

VOTING & ELECTIONS

Vote / Ballot Casting or recording a vote; the ballot icon `fa-check-to-slot`	**Polling Place** Where to vote in person `fa-person-booth`	**Absentee / Mail** Mail and absentee ballots `fa-envelope-open-text`	**Election Date** Election days and deadlines `fa-calendar-days`	**Voter ID** ID requirements `fa-id-card`
Registration Registering and checking status `fa-clipboard-check`	**Your District** Address and district lookup `fa-map-location-dot`	**Contests / Measures** Races and ballot measures on a ballot `fa-list-check`	**Results** Vote totals and results `fa-square-poll-vertical`	**Unofficial / Pending** Results not yet certified `fa-hourglass-half`

About ballot icons. Font Awesome's literal ballot-paper and ballot-box icons are Pro-only, so `check-to-slot` (a check-marked ballot dropping into a slot) is the free equivalent and is the one ballot icon on the site. Don't substitute the ballot-box emoji: it renders differently on every OS. If a literal ballot illustration is wanted later, it would be a commissioned custom set, not a one-off.

11 — ICONOGRAPHY

Government, Functional & Rules

GOVERNMENT & RECORDS

Government / Capitol
Offices, the executive branch, the Capitol
`fa-landmark`

Legislature & Bills
General Assembly, bills, votes
`fa-gavel`

Courts & Justice
Judicial branch, rulings
`fa-scale-balanced`

Document
Bills, filings, official text
`fa-file-lines`

Executive Order
Orders, signed actions
`fa-file-signature`

Campaign Finance
Raised, spent, donors
`fa-sack-dollar`

News
Coverage and press
`fa-newspaper`

Flag at Half-Staff
Observances and notices
`fa-flag`

Emergency / Warning
Emergencies; always with a label
`fa-triangle-exclamation`

Data Note
Notes on data sources and limits
`fa-circle-info`

FUNCTIONAL UI

Search
Search and lookup
`fa-magnifying-glass`

Next
Next page or step
`fa-arrow-right`

Previous
Back / previous
`fa-arrow-left`

Email
Contact by email
`fa-envelope`

Phone
Contact by phone
`fa-phone`

External
Opens another site
`fa-up-right-from-square`

Do. Pair every icon with a visible text label — the icon supports the words, never replaces them (mark icons `aria-hidden`). Size at 1em inline, 16–24px in UI, 32px+ on feature tiles. Default to Ink; use Deep Clay for emphasis, Pine for confirmed states, Danger Red only for emergencies. Add new icons by extending this table, one meaning each.

Don't. Use two different icons for one idea, or one icon for two. Use a party disc, Democratic blue or Republican red on a non-party icon. Mix outline and solid styles, use emoji, or draw one-off custom icons. Use the star for anything except Current Officeholder.

IN CONTEXT

★ Current Officeholder · Election Day: November 3, 2026 · Find your polling place · Certified results · Raised $2.4M

12 — DATA VISUALIZATION

Charts: Color & Construction

Charts exist to be read, so they follow two rules: party colors mean party and nothing else, and every number is visible as text, never only as a shape. Examples on this page use illustrative data, not real figures.

PARTY SERIES (SEMANTIC)

Democratic
`#3333ff`
Party color

Republican
`#e81b23`
Party color

Independent
`#a21caf`
Party color

Vacant
`#9ca3af`
Vacant

Only for series that are parties. Order is always Democratic, Republican, Independent, Vacant.

NON-PARTY CATEGORIES (UP TO 4 + REST)

Clay
`#b4521f`
Series 1
4.9:1 on page

Pine
`#2f5d50`
Series 2
7.2:1 on page

Slate
`#5b6470`
Series 3
5.8:1 on page

Ochre
`#b7791f`
Series 4
3.5:1 on page

Clay Line
`#e6c9b0`
Other / rest

For anything that isn't a party: finance categories, branches, topics. No blue, red or magenta.

SEQUENTIAL RAMP (MAGNITUDE, E.G. DISTRICT MAPS BY TURNOUT OR DOLLARS)

Seq 1
`#fbefe4`
Lowest

Seq 2
`#e6c9b0`

Seq 3
`#d08a5c`

Seq 4
`#b4521f`

Seq 5
`#8a3b12`
Highest

EXAMPLES

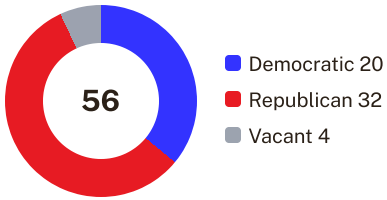
Chamber composition



Democratic 20 Republican 30 Independent 2 Vacant 4

ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

Share of a whole



ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

Campaign finance



ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

12 — DATA VISUALIZATION

Choosing & Building a Chart

WHICH FORM

QUESTION	USE
Look up exact values	**Table** (the default for most data)
Compare a few items	Horizontal bars, zero baseline
Composition of a whole (seats, votes)	Single stacked bar; donut only for up to 4 parts
Change over time	Line, labeled at the ends
Geography (districts)	Map, party fills or sequential ramp

CONSTRUCTION

ELEMENT	RULE
Labels	Label directly on or beside marks; legends only when direct labels don't fit
Numbers	Every value shown as text, formatted as elsewhere ($2.4M, 1,234)
Baseline	Bars start at zero. No truncated axes
Segments	2px gap in the page color between adjacent segments
Source	Data stamp under every chart: "Data last updated … Source …"

Accessibility. Graphical marks need 3:1 against their background. Party is always also named in text (never hue alone), because blue, red and magenta can blur for some readers. Adjacent series differ in lightness, not only hue. Every chart has a text equivalent: a nearby table, or an `aria-label` that states the numbers.

Don't. Use party colors for non-party data, or red/green for good/bad. No 3D, no pies over 4 slices, no dual axes, no gradients or shadows, no decorative animation. Don't imply a trend from two points.

MISSING, ZERO AND UNKNOWN

Zero
A real zero draws no bar but prints **$0** or **0**. It is a finding.

Unknown
Not reported or not matched: print — or "Not available" with a gray hatched track. Never draw it as zero.

Partial
If a series covers only part of the period, say which part in a data note beneath the chart.

13 — CONTENT & DATA-STATE PATTERNS

Editorial Conventions

What the site says, and how it writes numbers, dates and gaps. Where code already enforces a convention it is named, so the guide and the site stay one source of truth.

TOPIC	STANDARD	EXAMPLE
Party names	Use the party adjective: Democratic, Republican, Independent. Abbreviate to D / R / I only beside a legend or in tight tables. Never “Democrat Party”; never “Rep.” for Republican, since it is the title for Representative.	Democratic · D Republican · R
Titles	Sen. and Rep. before names in lists; full title on first mention in prose.	Sen. Jon Ossoff
Role words	Describe the position, not the person. “Current Officeholder”, “Challenger”, “Open Seat”. No adjectives about candidates.	★ Current Officeholder
Claims	Attribute every figure and statement to its source. Say what a record shows, not what it means.	“According to FEC filings…”
Dates	Long form in text and stamps. Short form (Oct 8, 2026) only in tables. Never ISO. Date-only values are local calendar dates, so no stamp reads a day early.	October 20, 2026
Money	$ with K / M abbreviations: one decimal for millions, none for thousands, whole dollars below $1,000. Negative with a minus.	$2.4M · $850K · $999
Numbers	Thousands separators from 1,000. Counts as digits. Percentages as whole numbers.	1,234 votes · 52%
Unknown values	An em dash (—) in tables; “Not available” in sentences. Never a blank, never 0 for unknown.	Raised: —
Provenance	Every dataset carries its own stamp from its own timestamp: “Data last updated: date · Source: name · Open data”. Link the published dataset, not the internal file.	Data last updated: October 20, 2026 · Source: Congress.gov API
Links	Name the destination, not “click here”. External links open in a new tab with the up-right icon.	View on Congress.gov

13 — CONTENT & DATA-STATE PATTERNS

When Data Isn’t There

A civic site is judged on how it handles gaps. There are three different situations, and each must read differently. **A failure must never look like an empty result**: “we couldn’t load it” is not “there is none”.

1 · EMPTY (A REAL RESULT)

No campaign finance filing found for this candidate in the 2026 cycle.

Neutral gray text. State what was checked and the scope. No apology, no icon needed.

⚠ 2 · TEMPORARILY UNAVAILABLE

We couldn’t load this member’s voting record just now. This is a temporary problem on our end, not a sign they have no record. Please reload to try again.

Amber callout. Say it is us, say it is not a finding, give a next step (reload, or a link to the primary source).

ⓘ 3 · KNOWN GAP

Our vote-matching data has known gaps for a small number of legislators. If this looks wrong, check the member’s official page on legis.ga.gov.

Gray data note. Name the limitation honestly and point to the official source.

LOADING & STALE

STATE	PATTERN
Loading	“Loading…” in gray, in the space the content will occupy so the page doesn’t jump.
Stale (proposed)	If a dataset is older than its normal refresh, tint the stamp amber and add “older than usual”. Not built yet.
User-fixable error	The one place for Danger Red: an unrecognized ZIP or address, with what to change.

WRITING THE MESSAGE

Do. Say what happened, whose side it is, and what to do next, in two sentences or fewer. Plain words. Link to the primary source when there is one.

Don’t. Use “API”, “JSON” or error codes. Blame the reader. Show a bare blank or “0” where the data failed.

Rollout note. The messages above already exist on the site, but their colors vary: “temporarily unavailable” appears in red (#c00) on some pages and in gray or amber on others, and the grays are ad hoc (#777, #666). Standardizing on the three treatments above is a small code change, separate from this guide.

14 — SOCIAL & SHARE CARDS

Share Card Templates

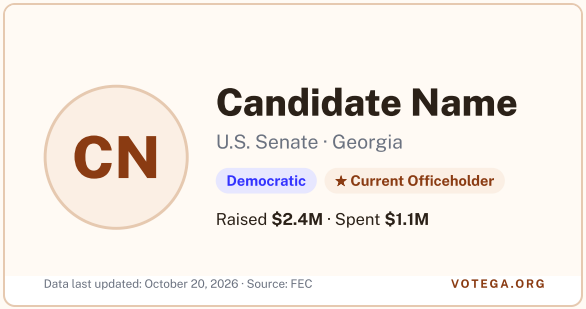
A link shared to a group chat or feed is often the first time someone sees VoteGA. Cards follow the same rules as the site: warm ground, the Georgia lockup, one fact, one source. Party color appears only on party badges and data marks, never as the card's background.

DEFAULT CARD



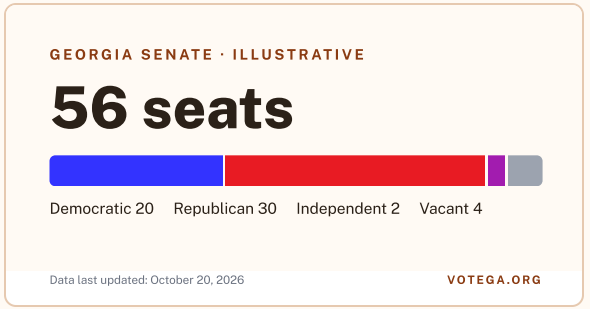
Pages with no image of their own. Replaces today's navy-and-blue card.

ENTITY CARD (PERSON / RACE)



Legislators, candidates, races. Same layout for every candidate in a race.

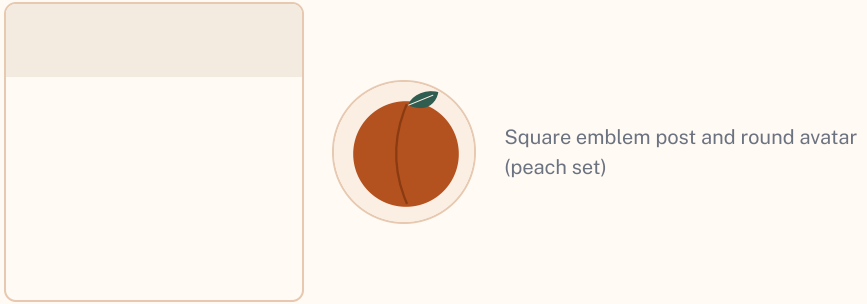
DATA CARD (RESULTS / COMPOSITION)



One headline number, one chart, the stamp. Party colors only on the data.

FORMATS

USE	SIZE	NOTES
Link card (OG / Twitter)	1200×630	Already set to summary_large_image
Square post	1080×1080	Emblem or data card (proposed)
Profile avatar	400×400	Round crop; peach set
Cover / banner	1500×500	Horizontal lockup, left-aligned (proposed)



Square emblem post and round avatar (peach set)

RULES

Do. Keep text inside a 64px margin (platforms crop sides). Nothing under 24px on the 1200px canvas; headline at 48px or more. 4.5:1 text contrast. Include the data stamp and domain. Use portraits only when they come from a government source; otherwise the monogram placeholder. Alt text states the card's content in a sentence.

Don't. Use campaign, social-media or stock photos, flag or eagle imagery, party symbols as backgrounds, emoji or partisan hashtags. Don't color a card by the person's party. Don't make two candidates' cards in the same race differ in layout.

14 — SOCIAL & SHARE CARDS

Posting & Implementation

CAPTION PATTERN

```
[What it is] [number or fact], per [source], as of [date].
votega.org/[page]
```

Example (illustrative). Candidate Name has raised $2.4M and spent $1.1M, per FEC filings, as of October 20, 2026. votega.org/candidates/candidate-name
One fact, attributed and dated, with a link to the page. No adjectives about people or parties.

FIELD	RULE
Title	Entity or page name, then the site. Under 60 characters.
Description	One factual sentence, under 200 characters, set with share-description. No opinion.
Image	Page-specific card, else the default. Set with share-img.

VOICE ON SOCIAL

Do. Same voice as the site: factual, plain, sourced. Correct errors in public and fast, naming what changed. Treat both parties' accounts and candidates the same: same frequency, same format.

Don't. React to news with commentary, quote-post a candidate with an opinion, or engage in arguments about who is right. Link the record instead.

WHERE THE CURRENT SETUP STANDS

Rollout notes. The default card (og-default.png, built from tools/og-image/og-default.html) still uses the old navy, civic blue and action blue with a blue VOTE / blue GA wordmark. Regenerate it from the Peach & Clay template above. Per-page entity cards are not yet generated; they are a larger build and these templates are the design for it. Entity and race cards should reuse the badge and icon rules from this guide.

15 — LEGAL & ATTRIBUTION

Licenses, Credit & Provenance

What VoteGA publishes, under what terms, and how it credits what it didn't make. These summarize the repository's NOTICE.md and LICENSE; those files govern. This guide is a working reference, not legal advice.

WHAT IS LICENSED HOW

MATERIAL	LICENSE / STATUS	NOTES
Site content and published datasets	**CC BY-SA 4.0**	Share and adapt, including commercially, with credit; adaptations carry the same license
Site source code	**PolyForm Noncommercial 1.0.0**	Scripts, JavaScript, templates, workflows
Third-party components	**Their own licenses**	Listed in THIRD-PARTY-NOTICES.md
VoteGA name and logo	**Reserved, not licensed**	Do not use in a way that suggests endorsement
Earlier releases	**MIT up to tag last-mit-release**	Remain available under MIT

CREDIT LINE FOR REUSE

```
Source: VoteGA.org (https://www.votega.org), CC BY-SA 4.0.
```

Underlying facts come from public and government sources whose own terms may apply to anything redistributed. Point reusers to /about-the-data and /open-data. Every published dataset repo carries this notice automatically.

FOOTER LICENSE LINE (ON EVERY PAGE)

Content and data: CC BY-SA 4.0 · Code: PolyForm Noncommercial 1.0.0 · Name and logo reserved

FONTS, ICONS AND BRAND ASSETS

MATERIAL	LICENSE / STATUS	NOTES
Public Sans	**SIL OFL 1.1**	Google Fonts; add to THIRD-PARTY-NOTICES.md on rollout
Font Awesome Free	**Icons CC BY 4.0, fonts OFL, code MIT**	Keep the license header in the stylesheet
Georgia outline	**US Census data, public domain**	Cartographic boundary file, cb_2025_us_state_500k
Party discs	**Party symbols**	Used only to identify affiliation; see page 10
Portraits	**Government sources only**	Campaign photos are linked, never re-hosted

15 — LEGAL & ATTRIBUTION

Disclaimers, Privacy & Brand Use

NON-AFFILIATION (STANDARD WORDING)

VoteGA.org is an independent informational website and is not supported by any political party or candidate. It is not affiliated with, authorized by, or endorsed by any politicians or any other organization it mentions.

Place on About, in the footer of press materials, and wherever party marks or candidate names appear prominently.

PRIVACY COMMITMENTS

Analytics	Aggregate and anonymous only; no profiles, no sale of data.
Address lookups	Sent only to the U.S. Census geocoder to find districts; never to our analytics, never stored.
Say it where it matters	Repeat the address note beside every lookup field, in plain words.

CORRECTIONS

Anyone can report an error to **admin@votega.org** or on the relevant GitHub dataset repo. Acknowledge it, verify against the primary source, fix it, and say what changed. People and campaigns get the same process as anyone else.

USING THE NAME AND LOGO (PROPOSED)

OK without asking. Naming VoteGA in text, linking to the site, and screenshots of pages with the credit line. News and civic organizations referencing the data with attribution.

Ask first. Putting the logo on partner or promotional materials, co-branding, merch, or any use beside a candidate, party or campaign.

Never. Use the name or logo to imply endorsement, alter or recolor the marks, or place them on a campaign or party piece.

PARTY MARKS AND PORTRAITS

Party discs identify affiliation only, always as a pair, never as endorsement (see Party Colors). Portraits come from government sources; anything else is credited and licensed, or not used.

OWNERSHIP

Rights are intended to be assigned to a nonprofit when one is formed. A trademark filing for the name and logo is worth making then; until it happens, treat the reserved-name line as the working position.

Brand-use permissions and the privacy wording are proposals drawn from existing site text; have counsel review them before they are published as policy.

16 — LAYOUT & BREAKPOINTS

One Set of Breakpoints

The site runs on Bootstrap 4 through the Beautiful Jekyll theme, plus component CSS written page by page. Counting every media query in the layouts, includes, stylesheets and pages gives about fifteen different widths. The guide proposes three, and a rule for where the stragglers go.

PROPOSED SCALE

NAME	WIDTH	WHAT CHANGES
Small	≤ 600px	Single column. Card grids go from 2 columns to 1. Filter pills wrap. Tables scroll inside their own container.
Medium	768px (theme)	Navbar collapses. Entity sidebar moves below the main column. Tab bars wrap.
Wide	≥ 1200px (theme)	Full container width; entity pages show the main column with the sticky sidebar.

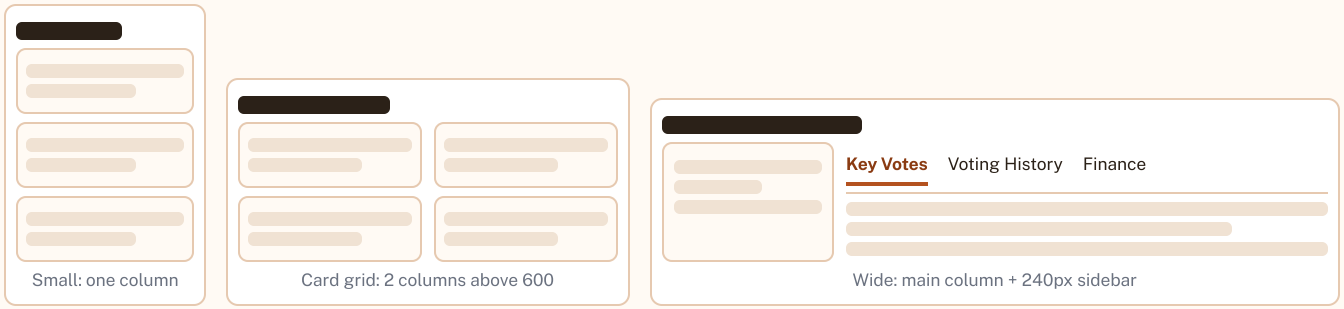
768 and 1200 are the theme's own breakpoints; 600 is the one component breakpoint the site already uses most.

WHERE THE CURRENT WIDTHS LAND

USED TODAY	TIMES	BECOMES
600px	10	**Small** (keep)
768 / 767px	8 + 3	**Medium** (keep)
1200 / 1199px	5 + 3	**Wide** (keep)
480, 500, 520, 540, 560	13	Small
640, 700, 720, 760	8	Medium or Small, per component

Counts come from a search of the repository. This is a cleanup to do page by page as pages are touched, not one sweep.

WHAT EACH SIZE LOOKS LIKE



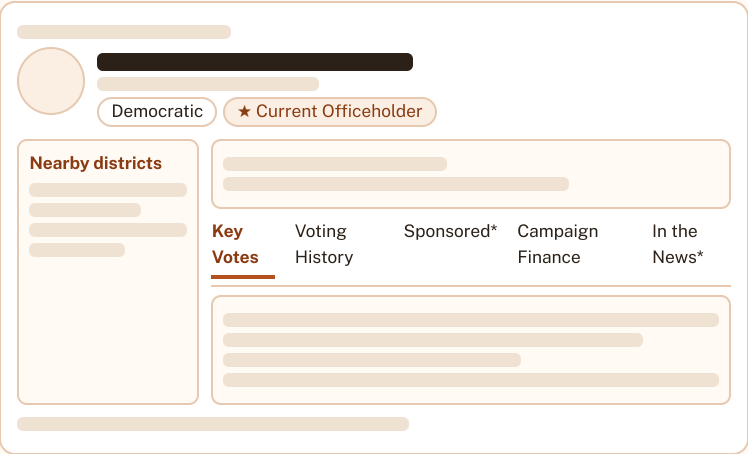
Do. Write component CSS against the three names, with max-width queries to match what the site already does. Test every page at 375px, 768px and 1280px. Keep text lines readable: no full-width paragraphs on wide screens.

Don't. Add a new one-off width for a single component. Hide data on small screens: reflow or scroll it instead. Let a table push the page wider than the screen.

17 — PAGE ANATOMY

Entity Profile Pages

Legislators, candidates, races and executives share one shape, so a reader who has learned one profile can read any other. Wireframe below is the person profile (federal and Georgia legislators); variants follow.



READING ORDER

1 Breadcrumb, then name, role, and the party and role badges.
2 Summary and contact, plain text first.
3 Tabs: **Key Votes** (default), **Voting History**, **Sponsored Legislation**, **Campaign Finance**, **In the News**.
4 Sidebar: nearby districts or the delegation; sticky on wide screens, below the content at Medium.
5 Data stamp last, per dataset.

* Shown only when there is something to show.

Tabs
Order is fixed: curated first (Key Votes), then the complete record. A tab for data that doesn't exist is **omitted**, never disabled. "In the News" stays hidden until it has items. Every tab follows the data-state patterns: loading, empty, unavailable, known gap.

Variants
Candidate: header, Also on the ballot, Campaign Finance, In the News, Service History.
Race: candidate cards in one layout, then a Campaign Finance comparison tab.
Executive: tabs follow the role: Executive Orders and Signed Legislation, Tie-Breaking Votes (Vice President), Agency Rules & Regulations (Cabinet).

Place pages
County and city pages (/local/...) should follow the same header, tabs and stamp. New entity types should too: copy this shape, change the tab names, keep the order logic (curated, then complete).

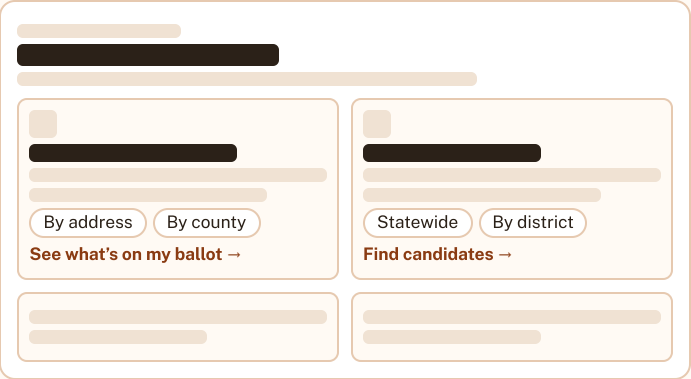
Do. Put the same facts in the same place on every profile. Give each tab panel its own heading and stamp. Keep deep links working: opening #votingHistory lands on that tab.

Don't. Reorder tabs per person, add a tab that duplicates another, or make a profile longer by repeating data from a tab above it.

18 — HUB & RESULTS PAGES

Hub Pages

A hub (Elections, Find My Reps) is a short page of cards that send people to the right tool. It doesn't show data itself.

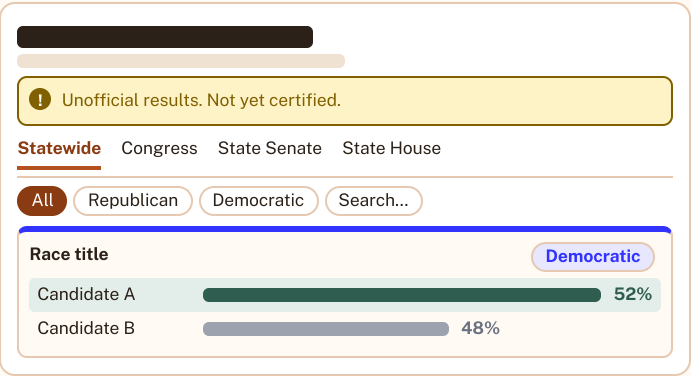


Card = icon, title, one-sentence description, topic chips, call to action ending in an arrow.
Order by what a voter most needs to do. "What's on My Ballot" comes first.
Grid two columns, one at Small. Cards are links in full, with a clear focus ring.
Style Clay Line border, 10px radius, Clay Tint on hover. Icons from the icon system; Georgia pages carry no party color.

18 — HUB & RESULTS PAGES

Results Pages

One layout serves every election (primary, runoff, special, general). A page is a stub that points at a data file; the layout supplies the structure, and the status of the data decides what the page says.



Header heading, then a meta line: subtitle · election date · last updated.
Status notice resolved from the data, not typed in by hand: **Upcoming** (no votes counted), **Unofficial** (reported, not certified), **Certified**.
Tabs by section, then **filters** (party pills, search), then **race cards**.
Race card a party-colored top border, title, status badge, candidate rows with vote bars and percentages. A clear winner, or a runoff under the Georgia majority rule, is marked in text.

18 — HUB & RESULTS PAGES

Results Rules & Rollout Notes

STATUS TREATMENTS (PROPOSED)

STATUS	LABEL	TREATMENT
Upcoming	“Results not yet reported”	Neutral gray note; hourglass icon; no winners
Unofficial	“Unofficial results”	Amber notice; hourglass icon; leading candidate marked as leading, not as winner
Certified	“Certified results”	Pine notice; check icon; winner or runoff stated

Going live. A page staged before an election carries noindex, sitemap: false and search: false so it can’t be found until it means something. Removing those three flags is the whole launch. The layout shows **Upcoming** until the first vote is in, whatever the front matter says.

RULES

Do. Present candidates and parties in identical layouts and order, with the same data on every row. Say plainly what the numbers are and when they were updated. State a result only as the data supports it: above 50% wins; otherwise the top finishers advance to a runoff.

Don’t. Call a race before the data does. Use party color for anything but the party badge, the card border and the party-coded bar. Drop the unofficial notice because a race looks decided.

ROLLOUT NOTES: WHERE THE LIVE PAGES DIFFER FROM THIS GUIDE

- **Hub cards use emoji icons** (clipboard, ballot box, calendar). The icon system bans emoji; replace with Font Awesome list-check, check-to-slot and calendar-days.
- **The results layout defines its own colors:** a Republican red #c0392b, a Democratic blue #2471a3, blue tab and link states #1a56a8, and a navy active filter #1a1a2e. They should become the guide’s party colors, with clay for tabs and filters, which also removes blue from non-party UI.
- **Hub and result cards use #ddd borders and #fff fills;** the guide uses Clay Line borders and Clay Tint hover.
- **Page-level pieces to reuse, not rebuild:** the status resolver result-status.html and the shared tab component already do the heavy lifting.

19 — OPEN ITEMS

Decisions & Follow-ups

A running list of what is still undecided, unbuilt or unconfirmed, so it can be picked up later. Page numbers point to where each item appears in this guide. Items marked “proposed” elsewhere in the guide are gathered here.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

- ☐ Brand Clay reads as a deep, burnt orange. Add a lighter “peach” token for the alternate set? p.3, p.4
- ☐ Light clay #e9a173 appears only on the reversed (dark) logo; adopt as a token or drop logo explorations
- ☐ Run a color-blind simulation on the non-party chart colors (Ochre, Slate) p.14
- ☐ Look at #3333FF in large chart areas (stacked bar, donut) beside the clay palette before locking it p.14
- ☐ Where the logo tagline appears; drop it under about 320px p.3
- ☐ Peach set scope: avatars and merch only, or also campaigns and the hybrid mark? p.3
- ☐ Georgia outline detail on large logos: keep the simplified shape or add the Sea Islands logo explorations
- ☐ Stale-data stamp: define a normal refresh window per dataset, then the “older than usual” rule p.17
- ☐ Results status labels and colors (Upcoming, Unofficial, Certified) p.25
- ☐ Ship a web app manifest and the 192/512 and maskable icons, or favicon and touch icon only favicon set

PROPOSED VALUES TO CONFIRM IN REAL USE

- ☐ Breakpoints 600 / 768 / 1200, and where the entity sidebar stacks p.22
- ☐ Party disc sizes (16 px min; 20–24 inline; 40–80 cards) p.10
- ☐ Logo clear space (¼ badge diameter) and minimum sizes p.3
- ☐ Social formats: square 1080, cover 1500×500; share-card margins and type sizes p.18
- ☐ Icon sizes: 1em inline, 16–24 UI, 32+ tiles p.13

DELIVERABLES NOT YET PRODUCED

- ☐ Swap the built logo set (assets/img/brand/logo/) into the site in place of logo.png; confirm the provisional reversed light clay p.3
- ☐ Regenerate the PDF from this HTML and replace the old style-guide.pdf —
- ☐ Archive or mark superseded the old PDF and the bundled “VoteGA Style Guide.html” —
- ☐ Commit and push the trial branch; decide on a PR and merge —
- ☐ Per-entity share cards (only the templates exist) and a regenerated default og-default.png p.18–19
- ☐ Real-browser check of the 16 px favicon on light and dark tabs favicon set

SITE ROLLOUT (CODE, SEPARATE FROM THE GUIDE)

- ☐ Shared tokens.css in two layers (palette values, then role tokens) so a dark theme can override roles later; replace hard-coded colors across pages; page CSS needs ?v= cache-busting —
- ☐ Switch Lora / Open Sans to Public Sans in base.html; add Public Sans to THIRD-PARTY-NOTICES.md p.5, p.20
- ☐ Wire the new favicon and touch icons into head.html favicon set
- ☐ New party colors (#3333FF, #E81B23, magenta #A21CAF) and Vacant gray across the tracker, charts and party code; stray blue #1a56a8 accent p.10
- ☐ Results layout colors and tab blue; hub emoji icons to Font Awesome p.25
- ☐ Standardize empty / unavailable / gap colors (#c00, #777, #666 today) p.17
- ☐ Collapse the 15 breakpoints toward three, page by page p.22
- ☐ Category dots set in JavaScript (e.g. Appointment #1a56a8) p.6

GUIDE SECTIONS NOT YET WRITTEN

- ☐ Accessibility standards, consolidated on one page scattered
- ☐ Imagery, portraits and district maps —
- ☐ Tokens and governance: versioning, who approves, how to propose a change —
- ☐ Motion; print and merch templates; email signature low priority

REVIEW NEEDED

- ☐ Counsel review: brand-use tiers, privacy wording, nonprofit ownership and trademark filing p.20–21